## Important terminologies

**Health:** Health is a state of complete physical, mental and social well-being and not merely the absence of disease or infirmity (WHO, 1948).

**Nutrient requirement:** It is defined as the minimum amount of the absorbed nutrient that is necessary for maintaining the normal physiological functions of the body.

**Calorie:** A calorie is the energy it takes to raise the temperature of I gram of water to 1 degree Celsius.

**Basal Metabolic Rate (BMR):** The amount of energy expended daily when the body is at complete rest.

**Dietary Fibre:** Dietary fibre delays the intestinal transit of the food consumed. Dietary fibre is important for proper bowel function, to reduce chronic constipation, diverticular disease, haemorrhoids, coronary heart diseases, diabetes and obesity. They protect against colon cancer.

**Antioxidants:** Antioxidants restrict the damage that reactive oxygen free radicals can cause cellular components. They are of primary biological value in giving protection from certain diseases. Raw and fresh vegetables like green leafy vegetables, carrots and fresh fruits including citrus fruits and tomatoes have been identified as good sources of antioxidants.

part of life. Hence, it is very essential to gain knowledge about food, its planning, preparation and service. Creative meal management for people at different age groups can add pleasure and satisfaction to their lives and ensure healthy living.

Vegans eat no foods of animal origin

### 6.1.1 Balanced Diet

A balanced diet is one which provides all the nutrients in required amounts and proper proportions so that the need for calories, proteins, minerals, vitamins and other nutrients are adequately met. It can be easily achieved through a blend of four basic food groups. The nutrient requirements vary with age, gender, physiological status and physical activity. A balanced diet provides **(i)** 50-60% of total calories from carbohydrates, **(ii)** about 10-15% from proteins **(iii)** and 20-30% from both visible and invisible fat. In addition, a balanced diet should provide other non-nutrients such as dietary fiber, antioxidants and phytochemicals.

### 6.1.2 Recommended Dietary Allowance (RDA)

The Recommended Dietary Allowances (RDA) presented are in estimates of nutrients to be consumed daily to ensure that the requirements of all individuals in a given population are met. The



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